

CONFIDENTIAL

A confidentiality clause imbues a trust in you and makes you look more professional

based on the project. If your fees are already disclosed to a potential client and that project merits a higher fee structure, you will be at a disadvantage in negotiating your fees. So protect yourself, protect the client and both of you can sleep easy at the end of the day.

Client relationship

A regularly overlooked point. You know you are a freelancer and not a bespoke exclusive resource for a single client. Different minds don't always think alike though. It's a good idea to specify that you are working with the company in the capacity of a freelancer and are not exclusive to them or their project. You would of course want to take up multiple projects and if you are focusing on a niche, work from the same space and with competing brands. So put in a point that not only you are not exclusive to the company, you are free to take up work of other brands and companies in the same sector. This is where the confidentiality clause serves to pacify the client.

As we saw, one of the most points in a contract is the rate/ charges clause. You need to specify if this is inclusive of taxes or not. If you are not living in a bubble, you have definitely heard of GST. Do you know how it affects you? Let's decode GST and how it affects you.

ST is Goods and Services Tax and since you provide a service, you fall in its ambit. This has replaced the previous taxes of VAT and Service Tax and such. But before you start hyperventilating, there is a clause. GST is mandatory only for those who have a turnover or revenues exceeding Rs.20 lakhs a year. If your revenue or income from freelancing is lower than that, you don't need to apply for GST and subsequently will not charge GST. The location of the clients across the country is immaterial in this case. Also, if you get most of your projects from overseas and payment is routed through Western Union or PayPal, GST is not required.